



GRUMBIEREDAAG UN FROUWASEGE 17. LENZING, 2019

ROBERT LUSCH (MIT DENKI ZUM BRIAN WEIS)
REV - D 7

Honoring: Frouwa

Items Needed

Potatoes, spring onions (scallions), and/or cabbage seeds, if planting

Bread (Datsch is preferred but not required; see Dutch Treats by William Woys Weaver, pp. 103-105 for traditional recipe; also posted in the Urglaawe Culinary Guild group on Facebook)

Beans (at least three but more is better)

Offerings to Butzemann (if applicable)

Treats for cats (if applicable; preferably something white, such as fish, white meat chicken, or dried catnip flowers)

Frouwa statuary (optional; Freya statuary is also appropriate)

Decorations (optional; flowers, etc.)

Ritual Description

Ritual: This is a simple fertility ritual that serves in Urglaawe as a devotional to Frouwa. Set up your devotional area (outdoors preferred) however works for you.

First, sow or plant potatoes, cabbage, or spring onions. Once they are in the ground, proceed.

Intonation of the Runes

Each rune intoned thrice: Schild, Gewwe, Yaahr

Der Aaruf - The Invocation

Invocations to Frouwa.

Liewi Frouwa

Haerrin vun Gnaade, Bracht, un Liewe

Bsuch mich heit

Un sei mei geehrti Gaschtin

Dear Frouwa

Lady of Grace, Beauty, and Love

Visit me today

And be my honored Guest

Der Grenslaaf – The Border Walk

Start at the rear door of your house. If you do not have a rear door, the front door is fine. While standing by the door, say the following chant:

*Ebbes Griene, Ebbes Schwatze
Ebbes Weisse fer Ihre Katze.
Backt mer Datsch am Frouwedaag,
Strae die Grimmle wu Sie mag,
Vum Eck zum Eck am Gaarderanft,
So wachse die Greider uff's Land*

*Something Green, Something Black
Something white for her cats,
One bakes Datsch on Frouwe's Day,
Scatter the crumbs where She wishes.
From corner to corner along the garden's edge,
So the plants grow on the land.*

Walk to the corner of your garden (if no garden, then to the corner of your property) closest to the door where you began. walk in a clockwise manner the perimeter of the garden or property, and, at the first corner or hard turn, scatter a few large crumbs of bread. While scattering, say the following blessing:

*Es fiehrt die Frouwa die Kieh zum Graut,
die Biene zum Fluck,
un die Pferd zum Zuck.*

*The Frouwa leads the cows to fodder,
the bees to flight,
and the horses to pull.*

Then take three beans and cast them into the interior of the yard (note, if you only have three beans, reserve them for the final corner or turn instead of casting them now). Proceed to continue to walk the perimeter, stopping at each corner or hard turn and repeating the scattering and the blessing. The beans are an offering to the land and to the land spirits, and you may hail them as you scatter the beans.

Once you have returned to your starting point, say your personal thanks to Frouwa, and drop any outdoor offerings to Her cats. If you have a Butzemann, make an offering to him as well.

Zum Schluss - In Closing

Thank the Frouwa for Her attention and attendance, and close the rite.

ABOUT GRUMBIEREDAAG (POTATO DAY)

This is the traditional Deutsch holiday of St. Gertrude's Day, known also by the name we use in Urglaawe of Grumbieredaag (Potato Day), which is the day we will honor the Frouwa. This is one tradition that the Christians have inadvertently kept alive, and we benefit from it. The Christian expression has been edited to reflect the needs of the Urglaawe tradition and to return this observance to its older roots.

Since the Deutsch population overwhelmingly identifies as Protestant or Anabaptist, the survival of this Catholic observance within the wider culture is interesting in its own right, even if it had been diminishing over time. Even many Christians acknowledge the heathen roots of the observance. While there are other connections that come up (particularly to Holle and to Freid/Frigg), Grimm (305) makes a connection between Gertrude and Frowa/Frouwa, and this is generally accepted by the Urglaawe community.

Potatoes have become a staple crop for the Deutsch since arrival, and tradition is that March 17 is the day to put potatoes in the ground. There are rituals to feed the Heinzelmänner or other Kowwold (kobolds) and to bring fertility to the garden. Specific foods include Datsch (a type of almost granola-like potato bread) and spring onions.

One thing I find important in this observance is the completion of the potato cycle. Potato bread from last year's harvest is consumed and offered to the land at the time that this year's crop is being planted.

Expect this description to grow as our understanding of this observance expands.